

AI-Enabled Engineering Goals & Objectives Framework

Refined Version: Associate Engineers to Architects + Engineering Manager

Aligned to zero failed projects, higher utilization, delivery-led growth, consulting mindset, AI enablement, and forward deployment engineering.

Executive Summary

This framework converts the organization vision into practical, measurable goals across engineering levels. It is designed for a services and consulting delivery organization that wants stronger delivery predictability, improved utilization, client trust, delivery-led growth, AI-first engineering, and a gradual shift toward forward deployment engineering.

The recommended model keeps 90% of the performance framework standardized by role for fairness, consistency, and calibration. The remaining 10% should be customized based on project context, client needs, technology stack, individual career path, utilization situation, and account priorities.

Recommended positioning statement

Our performance goals are designed to create a delivery organization that consistently achieves zero failed projects, improves utilization, enables delivery-led growth, develops a consulting mindset, and accelerates AI-first engineering. Every role will be measured on project delivery, AI enablement, consulting impact, people contribution, and compliance. While 90% of the framework is standardized by role to ensure fairness and consistency, 10% will be customized based on project context, client needs, technology stack, and individual career aspirations.

Strategic Goal Categories

Goal Area	Recommended Weight	Purpose
Project Delivery & Engineering Excellence	40-50%	Delivery predictability, quality, ownership, technical contribution, delivery ownership, and zero-failure execution.
AI Enablement, Automation & GenAI Upskilling	15-25%	AI-assisted delivery, agentic development, productivity improvements, reusable automations, and responsible AI practices.
Consulting Mindset & Client Impact	10-20%	Business understanding, proactive communication, client-value thinking, solution recommendations, and delivery-led growth.
People, Collaboration & Mentorship	10-20%	Collaboration and knowledge contribution for junior roles; formal mentorship, onboarding, capability development, and team maturity from Senior Engineer and above.
Utilization, Process & Compliance	5-10%	Billability, timesheets, delivery governance, security, audit readiness, and organizational discipline.

Market-aligned engineering organizations increasingly measure performance through outcomes, quality, reliability, collaboration, and business impact - not just activity completion. DORA-style measures such as deployment frequency, lead time, change failure rate, and recovery time are useful signals for engineering health and zero-failure governance. AI goals should similarly focus on measurable productivity, quality, cycle-time, knowledge, and client-value improvements, rather than tool usage alone.

Core Principles for All Roles

Principle	Meaning in Performance Goals
Zero failed project mindset	Every engineer is accountable for early risk identification, transparent communication, quality, and predictable delivery.
Delivery-led growth	Delivery teams create growth through client trust, reusable assets, accelerators, automation, consulting insights, and expansion opportunities.
AI-first engineering behavior	Every role uses approved AI responsibly for coding, testing, documentation, analysis, automation, estimation, learning, and knowledge discovery.

Principle	Meaning in Performance Goals
Consulting mindset	Engineers should understand business context, ask better questions, identify gaps, and recommend improvements instead of only executing tickets.
Forward deployment engineering	Teams move closer to client problems through discovery, rapid prototyping, implementation, adoption, feedback, and measurable business outcomes.
Utilization with value	Utilization includes billable delivery, reusable IP, pre-sales support, internal accelerators, AI adoption, and account growth contribution.
Evidence-based performance	Performance is supported by delivery outcomes, code quality, sprint predictability, client feedback, CSAT/NPS signals, AI use cases, mentorship outcomes for senior levels, and compliance evidence.

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Common Metrics Library

Use this metrics library to make goals measurable without overcomplicating the appraisal process. Not every project needs every metric. Each project should select the metrics that best fit its delivery model.

Delivery Metrics

Metric	What It Measures
Sprint commitment reliability	Planned vs completed work and ability to meet commitments.
Defect leakage	Bugs reaching QA, UAT, or production.
Rework percentage	Effort spent fixing avoidable issues.
Production incidents	Stability, release quality, and operational readiness.
Change failure rate	Failed releases, rollbacks, hotfixes, or production-impacting changes.
Lead time	Time from requirement or code change to production readiness.
Risk reporting timeliness	How early risks, blockers, and dependencies are raised.
Client satisfaction / CSAT / NPS	Stakeholder confidence, CSAT, NPS, appreciation, escalations avoided, and qualitative client feedback. For Senior Engineer and above, these are adjacent supporting attributes for client impact.

AI Enablement Metrics

Metric	What It Measures
AI-assisted delivery adoption	Use of approved AI tools in daily engineering workflows.
AI productivity improvement	Time saved in coding, testing, documentation, analysis, or support.
AI use cases implemented	Project-specific or internal automation use cases created.
Agentic development contribution	Agents, prompt chains, workflows, reusable scripts, or SDLC accelerators.
AI governance adherence	Secure, compliant, human-reviewed AI usage.
Knowledge assets created	Prompt libraries, playbooks, templates, patterns, or examples.
AI-enabled quality improvement	Better test generation, code review support, defect prevention, or analysis quality.

Consulting and Growth Metrics

Metric	What It Measures
Client problem understanding	Ability to connect technical work to business value.
Solution recommendations	Practical improvement options and trade-off thinking.
Expansion support	Identification of new work, automation, modernization, or AI opportunities.
Client demo / presentation impact	Client-facing demos, technical walkthroughs, solution presentations, or trainings that improve stakeholder confidence, CSAT, NPS, adoption, or expansion potential. Internal demos/PPTs/trainings are good-to-have enablement, but should not outweigh client impact.
Domain learning	Understanding of client industry, process, and business workflows.
Reusable solution contribution	Accelerators, templates, frameworks, and reference implementations.

People and Compliance Metrics

Metric	What It Measures
Mentee progress - Senior+	Skill growth, independence, quality, and ownership improvement for mentees. Formal mentorship starts from Senior Engineer and above.
Code review quality	Constructive review comments that prevent defects and improve maintainability.
Knowledge sharing	Sessions, internal demos, documentation, and reusable learning assets.
Timesheet compliance	Accurate and timely effort reporting.
Security compliance	Secure coding, data protection, client-specific controls, and policy adherence.
Audit readiness	Evidence, traceability, documentation, decisions, and approvals.

How to Treat Internal Enablement vs Client Impact

Internal demos, PPTs, brown-bag sessions, and training sessions are valuable for organizational enablement, knowledge sharing, and team maturity. However, they should be treated as supporting evidence, not primary client-impact evidence. For Senior Engineer and above, higher-value evidence should be tied to client-facing impact and CSAT/NPS-adjacent signals.

Activity Type	How It Should Be Valued	Examples of Strong Evidence
Internal demo / PPT / training	Good-to-have enablement metric. Useful for capability building but usually not enough by itself for high impact.	Internal knowledge session, reusable deck, brown-bag training, project playbook, internal AI demo.
Client demo / solution walkthrough	High-value client impact metric when it improves confidence, adoption, delivery trust, or growth.	Client demo appreciation, business stakeholder alignment, acceptance of solution, reduced ambiguity, follow-up opportunity.
Client training / adoption support	High-value when it improves usage, handover quality, support readiness, CSAT, or NPS.	Client users trained, adoption blockers reduced, UAT smoother, support tickets reduced, stakeholder feedback positive.
CSAT / NPS adjacent attributes - Senior+	Supporting indicators for senior levels and above. Direct CSAT/NPS may not always be individually attributable, so use adjacent evidence.	Positive client feedback, fewer escalations, faster issue resolution, stakeholder trust, repeat work, extension, adoption, appreciation mail.

Associate Engineer

Role intent

Associate Engineers should become reliable contributors who deliver assigned tasks with guidance, learn the project ecosystem, follow engineering standards, and adopt AI-assisted development responsibly.

Recommended weightage

Goal Area	Weight
Project Delivery & Engineering Excellence	45%
AI Enablement & Upskilling	25%
People, Process & Collaboration	15%
Consulting Mindset & Business Awareness	5%
Utilization & Compliance	10%

Project Delivery & Engineering Excellence - 45%

Objective: Deliver assigned development, testing, documentation, and support tasks with quality and predictability.

- Complete assigned sprint tasks with at least 85-90% predictability.
- Write clean, readable, maintainable code following project standards.
- Perform self-review, unit testing, and peer validation before handoff.
- Understand project architecture, module dependencies, coding standards, and deployment flow.
- Participate actively in standups, sprint planning, retrospectives, and defect triage.
- Raise blockers early instead of waiting until deadlines are impacted.
- Contribute to setup guides, API notes, test notes, and runbooks.

AI Enablement & Upskilling - 25%

Objective: Become AI-enabled in daily engineering execution.

- Complete at least one relevant technical certification or structured learning path.
- Use approved AI tools for code explanation, test case generation, documentation, debugging support, and learning.
- Create at least two reusable prompts, snippets, test templates, or mini-automation ideas useful for the team.
- Demonstrate responsible AI usage: no confidential data leakage, no blind copy-paste, and human validation required.
- Participate in at least one internal AI or GenAI enablement session.
- Show measurable improvement in productivity or quality through AI-assisted work.

People, Process & Collaboration - 15%

Objective: Become a dependable team member.

- Follow project processes for Jira or ADO updates, timesheets, code commits, pull requests, and status reporting.

- Actively seek feedback from senior engineer, lead, or architect as appropriate.
- Participate in code reviews and incorporate feedback without repeated mistakes.
- Maintain professional communication with team members.
- Contribute at least one learning note or project document per quarter.

Consulting Mindset & Business Awareness - 5%

Objective: Understand why the project matters to the client.

- Understand the client domain, basic business workflow, and end-user impact of assigned work.
- Ask clarifying questions before implementation.
- Identify small improvements in validation, logging, usability, or maintainability.
- Explain completed work in simple business terms when required.

Utilization & Compliance - 10%

Objective: Maintain expected utilization and compliance discipline.

- Maintain assigned utilization target.
- Submit timesheets accurately and on time.
- Complete mandatory security, compliance, and AI governance trainings.
- Follow secure coding and data handling practices.
- Maintain clean handover notes for assigned tasks.

Engineer

Role intent

Engineers should independently deliver user stories, own components, contribute to quality, use AI to improve productivity, and start developing client-facing and consulting behaviors while focusing on individual ownership, peer collaboration, and delivery contribution.

Recommended weightage

Goal Area	Weight
Project Delivery & Engineering Excellence	45%
AI Enablement & Automation	20%
Consulting Mindset & Client Impact	10%
Team Collaboration & Knowledge Contribution	15%
Utilization & Compliance	10%

Project Delivery & Engineering Excellence - 45%

Objective: Independently deliver quality engineering outcomes.

- Own assigned user stories or components from requirement clarification to development, testing, deployment support, and documentation.
- Maintain sprint predictability of 90% or above.
- Reduce avoidable rework through better analysis and self-review.
- Contribute to unit testing, automation testing, CI/CD improvements, and defect prevention.
- Participate in root cause analysis for defects and incidents.
- Improve code quality using static analysis, code review, and engineering standards.
- Support production releases and ensure smooth handover to QA and support teams.

AI Enablement & Automation - 20%

Objective: Use AI to improve project delivery quality and speed.

- Use approved AI tools for code generation assistance, test generation, documentation, refactoring suggestions, debugging, and technical research.
- Build or contribute to at least one project-level automation, AI-assisted workflow, or productivity improvement per half-year.
- Maintain examples showing measurable AI impact.
- Create reusable prompts or templates for repetitive project activities.
- Complete at least one certification or AI-related learning path relevant to the project.
- Validate all AI-generated output for correctness, security, and maintainability.

Consulting Mindset & Client Impact - 10%

Objective: Move from task execution to solution contribution.

- Understand business requirements and clarify assumptions before implementation.
- Identify improvement opportunities in workflow, usability, performance, or maintainability.

- Support demos, walkthroughs, or technical explanations when needed.
- Communicate risks and dependencies clearly to lead or senior engineer.
- Contribute to delivery-led growth by identifying small enhancements or automation opportunities.

Team Collaboration & Knowledge Contribution - 15%

Objective: Support team maturity through collaboration, peer quality practices, and reusable knowledge while focusing on individual ownership, peer collaboration, and delivery contribution.

- Provide meaningful peer code reviews and incorporate review feedback effectively.
- Share practical project notes, reusable snippets, troubleshooting steps, or implementation learnings.
- Help unblock peers on known modules without owning formal people-development goals.
- Support team ceremonies, documentation hygiene, and project knowledge base updates.
- Contribute to smoother onboarding through documents or setup notes when requested.

Utilization & Compliance - 10%

Objective: Maintain high utilization and process discipline.

- Maintain utilization target.
- Keep Jira or ADO, timesheets, documentation, and status updates current.
- Complete mandatory trainings and certifications.
- Follow security, privacy, and AI governance requirements.
- Ensure deliverables are traceable to requirements and acceptance criteria.

Senior Engineer

Role intent

Senior Engineers should own complex modules, drive technical quality, mentor engineers, reduce delivery risk, introduce AI-enabled engineering practices, and act as project-level technical anchors.

Recommended weightage

Goal Area	Weight
Project Delivery & Engineering Excellence	45%
AI Enablement, Automation & Agentic Contribution	20%
Team Mentorship & Technical Leadership	20%
Consulting Mindset & Client Impact	10%
Utilization & Compliance	5%

Project Delivery & Engineering Excellence - 45%

Objective: Own complex delivery areas with quality, predictability, and reduced risk.

- Own one or more modules, features, integrations, or workstreams end to end.
- Ensure technical design, implementation, testing, deployment readiness, and support are handled without major escalation.
- Maintain high sprint predictability and reduce defect leakage.
- Improve code quality, logging, observability, test coverage, performance, and reliability.
- Identify technical risks early and propose mitigation plans.
- Support release planning, production readiness reviews, and RCA.
- Contribute to architectural decisions within assigned modules.
- Ensure assigned work aligns with scalability, security, performance, and maintainability requirements.

AI Enablement, Automation & Agentic Contribution - 20%

Objective: Drive practical AI adoption within the project.

- Implement at least one AI-assisted project improvement such as test generation workflow, documentation assistant, code review checklist, defect analysis assistant, log summarization, or sprint reporting automation.
- Contribute to agentic development experiments such as coding agents, QA agents, story analysis agents, release note agents, or support triage agents.
- Mentor junior team members on safe and effective AI usage.
- Measure AI impact in cycle time reduction, quality improvement, or effort saved.
- Complete one relevant advanced certification or AI/software engineering learning path.
- Ensure responsible use of AI with human review, secure data handling, and quality validation.

Team Mentorship & Technical Leadership - 20%

Objective: Improve team capability and delivery maturity.

- Mentor at least 1-2 associate engineers or engineers.

- Conduct code reviews focused on correctness, design, maintainability, and security.
- Identify skill gaps and recommend learning plans for junior engineers.
- Help leads with estimation, task breakdown, technical planning, and risk identification.
- Conduct knowledge-sharing sessions on project architecture, domain, debugging, or AI usage.
- Support performance observation by giving timely feedback to leads and managers.

Consulting Mindset, Client Impact & CSAT/NPS Support - 10%

Objective: Contribute to client confidence, solution maturity, and positive CSAT/NPS signals.

- Participate in requirement clarification and technical discussions with client or team stakeholders.
- Translate business needs into technical implementation options.
- Suggest improvements that reduce cost, improve performance, or increase maintainability.
- Support client-facing demos, walkthroughs, or technical explanations when they improve client confidence, adoption, CSAT, NPS, or stakeholder trust.
- Identify potential change requests, automation opportunities, or value-add ideas.
- Contribute evidence for CSAT/NPS-adjacent impact such as appreciation notes, reduced escalations, faster issue closure, adoption improvements, or positive stakeholder feedback.

Utilization & Compliance - 5%

Objective: Maintain discipline and governance.

- Maintain utilization target.
- Ensure compliance with delivery processes, timesheets, documentation, and security guidelines.
- Support audit readiness and traceability.
- Ensure AI usage follows organizational and client policies.

Lead Engineer

Role intent

Lead Engineers should be accountable for technical delivery of a team or workstream, ensure zero-surprise execution, manage risks, mentor engineers, improve utilization, contribute to growth, and operationalize AI-enabled delivery.

Recommended weightage

Goal Area	Weight
Project Delivery & Technical Project Management	40%
AI Enablement & Forward Delivery Engineering	20%
Team Mentorship & People Leadership	20%
Consulting, Client Impact & Growth	15%
Compliance, Utilization & Governance	5%

Project Delivery & Technical Project Management - 40%

Objective: Lead successful delivery of assigned team or workstream with predictability and quality.

- Own end-to-end delivery of assigned workstream: planning, estimation, execution, risk management, quality, release readiness, and stakeholder communication.
- Maintain sprint and release predictability and reduce delivery surprises.
- Track and improve engineering metrics such as defect leakage, rework, test coverage, code quality, release readiness, and incident trends.
- Ensure technical decisions are documented and aligned with architecture.
- Lead RCA for major defects, missed commitments, or production issues.
- Escalate risks early with options, not just problems.
- Drive zero failed project behaviors: proactive governance, transparent reporting, dependency tracking, and quality gates.
- Ensure team members are effectively utilized and assigned to value-generating work.

AI Enablement & Forward Delivery Engineering - 20%

Objective: Move the team toward AI-enabled and forward-deployed engineering practices.

- Define and implement a project-level AI enablement plan.
- Identify repetitive delivery activities suitable for AI automation: sprint reporting, test case generation, documentation, log analysis, code review, requirement clarification, defect triage, and release notes.
- Build or sponsor at least one reusable AI or agentic accelerator per year.
- Coach team members on AI-assisted engineering practices.
- Measure AI adoption through effort saved, faster analysis, improved quality, better documentation, or reduced cycle time.
- Drive forward deployment behaviors: faster client feedback loops, prototypes, demos, solution validation, and adoption support.
- Ensure AI outputs are reviewed and governed.

Team Mentorship & People Leadership - 20%

Objective: Build a high-performing engineering team.

- Mentor senior engineers, engineers, and associate engineers.
- Own team-level capability development and skill-gap closure.
- Provide regular feedback on performance, quality, ownership, communication, and career growth.
- Help team members prepare for next-role readiness.
- Improve onboarding experience and reduce ramp-up time for new team members.
- Identify performance concerns early and partner with managers for resolution.
- Promote engineering discipline: reviews, testing, documentation, estimation, and ownership.

Consulting, Client Impact, CSAT/NPS & Growth - 15%

Objective: Become a trusted delivery and technical partner whose work improves client confidence, CSAT/NPS, and growth potential.

- Lead or participate in client-facing technical discussions, demos, planning meetings, risk reviews, and solution walkthroughs.
- Treat internal demos, PPTs, and trainings as good-to-have enablement; prioritize client-facing demos, adoption sessions, and executive-ready explanations as higher-value evidence.
- Translate client needs into technical execution plans.
- Identify value-add opportunities, automation ideas, change requests, or modernization opportunities.
- Contribute to account growth through delivery excellence, solution recommendations, and improved stakeholder confidence.
- Track adjacent CSAT/NPS indicators such as appreciation, reduced escalations, improved adoption, faster issue closure, and positive stakeholder feedback.
- Support pre-sales, estimation, or proposal inputs when requested.

Compliance, Utilization & Governance - 5%

Objective: Ensure governance discipline across the team.

- Maintain team utilization targets.
- Ensure accurate timesheets, project tracking, documentation, and reporting.
- Ensure mandatory trainings and compliance requirements are completed.
- Ensure secure coding and responsible AI usage practices.
- Maintain audit-ready project artifacts.

Engineering Manager

Role intent

Engineering Managers are delivery-owning technical people leaders who bridge client accountability, project execution, engineering quality, people management, utilization, and growth. Unlike Architects, who primarily own solution integrity and technical direction, Engineering Managers own day-to-day delivery outcomes, stakeholder confidence, team performance, project health, and measurable client success while remaining technically credible.

Recommended weightage

Goal Area	Weight
Delivery Ownership & Project Governance	35%
Client Success, CSAT/NPS & Delivery-Led Growth	20%
People Management, Mentorship & Team Performance	20%
Technical Oversight, AI Enablement & Engineering Excellence	20%
Utilization, Compliance & Financial Discipline	5%

Delivery Ownership & Project Governance - 35%

Objective: Own project or workstream delivery outcomes with zero-surprise execution, predictable governance, and proactive risk control.

- Own delivery planning, sprint/release governance, dependency tracking, escalation management, stakeholder communication, and delivery health reporting.
- Drive zero failed project behaviors through early risk identification, mitigation planning, RAID governance, quality gates, and transparent status communication.
- Ensure committed scope, timelines, quality, staffing, and release readiness are actively managed across the team.
- Track and improve delivery metrics such as sprint predictability, defect leakage, rework, production incidents, SLA adherence, change failure rate, and recovery time.
- Partner with leads, architects, QA, product owners, scrum masters, and client stakeholders to remove blockers and prevent delivery slippage.
- Ensure RCA is performed for major defects, missed commitments, production incidents, escalations, or client dissatisfaction, and drive corrective actions to closure.
- Maintain strong handover discipline, documentation, release notes, operational readiness, and project evidence for audits or governance reviews.

Client Success, CSAT/NPS & Delivery-Led Growth - 20%

Objective: Own client confidence and delivery-led growth signals through stakeholder trust, measurable outcomes, and business-value communication.

- Maintain regular client communication on delivery health, risks, trade-offs, decisions, and value delivered.
- Use CSAT, NPS, stakeholder feedback, appreciation, escalation trend, adoption, repeat work, and extension signals as supporting indicators of client success.
- Ensure client demos, solution walkthroughs, release reviews, and client trainings are outcome-oriented and tied to acceptance, adoption, or confidence improvement.

- Identify delivery-led growth opportunities such as automation, modernization, AI enablement, managed services expansion, platform improvements, or efficiency gains.
- Support account teams with project insights, estimation inputs, proposal support, case studies, success stories, or value-add recommendations when appropriate.
- Convert delivery credibility into trust by communicating options, risks, cost/schedule impact, and business value clearly.

People Management, Mentorship & Team Performance - 20%

Objective: Build and manage a high-performing, accountable, well-utilized engineering team.

- Own people-management responsibilities such as goal alignment, regular 1:1s, feedback, performance observation, career development, staffing inputs, and issue resolution.
- Mentor senior engineers, leads, and engineers on ownership, communication, delivery discipline, estimation, risk management, and stakeholder handling.
- Identify skill gaps and build capability plans aligned to project needs, utilization priorities, AI adoption, and career progression.
- Improve onboarding, ramp-up time, knowledge transfer, team morale, collaboration, and succession readiness.
- Address performance concerns early with specific evidence, improvement plans, coaching, and manager/HR alignment where required.
- Balance individual growth with project needs by ensuring the right people are assigned to the right work with clear accountability.

Technical Oversight, AI Enablement & Engineering Excellence - 20%

Objective: Ensure technical delivery is credible, AI-enabled, secure, maintainable, and aligned with architecture direction.

- Stay technically close enough to challenge estimates, identify design gaps, validate engineering assumptions, and understand delivery complexity.
- Work with architects and leads to ensure architecture decisions are understood, implemented correctly, and translated into executable delivery plans.
- Drive engineering excellence practices such as code review discipline, test automation, CI/CD hygiene, observability, release quality, secure coding, and documentation.
- Define a project-level AI enablement plan covering AI-assisted development, testing, documentation, reporting, defect analysis, onboarding, knowledge management, or support triage.
- Sponsor practical AI/agent accelerators that reduce effort, improve quality, increase delivery predictability, or improve client experience.
- Ensure responsible AI usage with human validation, client policy alignment, data protection, auditability, and quality controls.

Utilization, Compliance & Financial Discipline - 5%

Objective: Maintain utilization, process discipline, compliance, and responsible delivery economics.

- Maintain team utilization targets and actively manage allocation, ramp-up, bench risk, and value-generating assignments.
- Ensure accurate timesheets, forecast inputs, project tracking, status reports, documentation, and governance artifacts.

- Follow client and organizational policies for security, privacy, access, audit readiness, and responsible AI.
- Support financial discipline by monitoring scope changes, effort burn, productivity risks, non-billable leakage, and change request opportunities.
- Ensure mandatory trainings and compliance requirements are completed across the team.

Associate Architect

Role intent

Associate Architects should own solution design for modules, platforms, integrations, or project streams; support delivery teams; improve engineering standards; influence clients; and drive AI-enabled solutioning.

Recommended weightage

Goal Area	Weight
Architecture & Delivery Assurance	40%
AI-Enabled Architecture & Automation	20%
Consulting, Client Impact & Delivery-Led Growth	20%
Technical Leadership & Mentorship	15%
Compliance, Governance & Utilization	5%

Architecture & Delivery Assurance - 40%

Objective: Ensure technical solution quality, scalability, maintainability, and delivery feasibility.

- Own architecture or design for assigned modules, platforms, integrations, or solution areas.
- Produce clear architecture artifacts: HLD, LLD, integration design, data flow, security considerations, deployment view, and NFR mapping.
- Validate that implementation aligns with architecture.
- Participate in critical design reviews, code quality reviews, release readiness, and production issue RCA.
- Reduce architecture-related rework by improving upfront design clarity.
- Ensure scalability, security, performance, observability, resilience, and maintainability are addressed.
- Support project leads in estimation, technical planning, dependency mapping, and risk mitigation.
- Contribute to reusable architecture patterns and reference implementations.

AI-Enabled Architecture & Automation - 20%

Objective: Embed AI into architecture, delivery, and engineering workflows.

- Identify project or account-level AI opportunities: developer productivity, testing, knowledge management, support triage, documentation, analytics, modernization, code migration, or client-facing intelligence.
- Design at least one AI-enabled solution, accelerator, agent, or workflow aligned to project or account needs.
- Establish responsible AI guidelines for the project: data safety, hallucination control, validation, auditability, and human-in-the-loop review.
- Contribute to internal AI architecture playbooks, reusable prompts, agent patterns, or reference architectures.
- Guide teams on when to use AI, when not to use AI, and how to validate output.
- Measure AI impact through productivity, quality, cycle time, or client value.

Consulting, Client Impact, CSAT/NPS & Delivery-Led Growth - 20%

Objective: Support growth through technical trust, solution thinking, and positive CSAT/NPS signals.

- Engage with client stakeholders to clarify business problems, constraints, and success criteria.
- Present solution options with trade-offs, risks, cost, timeline, and impact.
- Identify modernization, automation, AI, cloud, data, security, or platform opportunities.
- Support account growth through solution proposals, assessments, demos, workshops, or technical POVs.
- Help convert delivery insights into growth opportunities.
- Demonstrate structured recommendations, business-value framing, and risk-aware decision-making.

Technical Leadership & Mentorship - 15%

Objective: Raise technical maturity across the team.

- Mentor leads, senior engineers, and engineers on design, architecture, debugging, AI adoption, and quality practices.
- Conduct architecture walkthroughs and knowledge-sharing sessions.
- Review critical designs and guide implementation teams.
- Build technical capability maps and learning recommendations.
- Support career progression of engineers moving toward senior or lead roles.
- Help establish engineering standards and reusable templates.

Compliance, Governance & Utilization - 5%

Objective: Ensure architecture governance and organizational discipline.

- Maintain utilization target.
- Ensure solution artifacts are audit-ready and client-ready.
- Follow security, privacy, compliance, and AI governance requirements.
- Participate in architecture governance boards or internal reviews where applicable.
- Ensure risks, assumptions, decisions, and dependencies are documented.

Architect

Role intent

Architects should be accountable for solution integrity, client trust, delivery assurance, consulting-led growth, engineering maturity, AI transformation, and forward deployment engineering adoption across accounts or large programs.

Recommended weightage

Goal Area	Weight
Architecture Strategy & Delivery Assurance	35%
AI Transformation & Forward Deployment Engineering	25%
Consulting, Client Influence & Delivery-Led Growth	20%
Technical Leadership, Mentorship & Org Capability	15%
Compliance, Governance & Utilization	5%

Architecture Strategy & Delivery Assurance - 35%

Objective: Own solution integrity and technical success across projects, accounts, or programs.

- Define architecture strategy aligned to client business goals and delivery constraints.
- Ensure solution designs are scalable, secure, maintainable, observable, and cost-conscious.
- Provide architecture governance across teams and workstreams.
- Reduce delivery risk through early design reviews, dependency analysis, NFR validation, and technical risk mitigation.
- Support zero failed projects by identifying weak signals early: unclear requirements, unstable architecture, poor test strategy, resource gaps, integration risks, or client misalignment.
- Guide teams through critical technical decisions and trade-offs.
- Ensure architecture decisions are documented and communicated.
- Support production readiness, operational readiness, and incident prevention.
- Create reusable architecture assets, accelerators, and reference patterns.

AI Transformation & Forward Deployment Engineering - 25%

Objective: Lead the organization shift toward AI-enabled and forward-deployed engineering.

- Define AI enablement roadmap for assigned account, practice, or delivery unit.
- Identify high-value AI use cases across discovery, estimation, design, development, testing, documentation, migration, support, observability, and client reporting.
- Establish agentic engineering patterns: coding agents, QA agents, documentation agents, support agents, knowledge agents, modernization agents, and delivery governance agents.
- Create reusable AI accelerators and adoption playbooks.
- Drive safe and governed AI adoption, including data protection, human validation, traceability, evaluation, and client approval.
- Measure AI impact at project or account level: cycle-time reduction, quality improvement, delivery predictability, cost avoidance, faster onboarding, and improved client experience.

- Enable forward deployment engineering: client problem discovery, rapid prototyping, solution validation, deployment, adoption, feedback loops, and measurable business outcomes.
- Coach leads and architects on how to convert AI experiments into production-grade delivery capability.

Consulting, Client Influence, CSAT/NPS & Delivery-Led Growth - 20%

Objective: Use architecture and delivery excellence to improve client trust, CSAT/NPS, and account growth.

- Build trusted advisor relationships with client technology and business stakeholders.
- Lead discovery workshops, architecture assessments, modernization reviews, AI opportunity assessments, and technical strategy sessions.
- Identify new opportunities from current delivery: automation, modernization, cloud migration, data platforms, AI use cases, security, observability, and platform engineering.
- Support proposals, estimations, RFPs, solution shaping, and executive presentations.
- Convert delivery credibility into growth.
- Communicate complex architecture decisions in business-friendly language.
- Help account teams position differentiated offerings.

Technical Leadership, Mentorship & Org Capability - 15%

Objective: Build scalable engineering and architecture capability.

- Mentor associate architects, lead engineers, and senior engineers.
- Define engineering standards, architecture templates, review checklists, AI usage playbooks, and quality gates.
- Build capability development plans for teams.
- Conduct internal architecture forums, case studies, demos, or brown-bag sessions.
- Improve technical hiring, onboarding, and evaluation processes where needed.
- Create reusable IP and practice-level assets.
- Identify future leaders and support succession planning.

Compliance, Governance & Utilization - 5%

Objective: Ensure governance and responsible delivery.

- Maintain utilization expectations appropriate to role.
- Ensure compliance with client security, data, privacy, audit, and AI policies.
- Ensure architecture reviews and decision records are maintained.
- Support internal quality audits and risk reviews.
- Ensure responsible use of GenAI and agentic tools in client contexts.

Fixed vs Customizable Goal Model

A strong performance system needs consistency and flexibility. The recommended split is 90% fixed by role and 10% customized to project, client, and individual context.

90% Fixed Goals

- Delivery quality and predictability
- AI enablement and responsible usage
- Utilization and compliance
- Team collaboration and mentoring appropriate to level
- Engineering excellence and process adherence
- Consulting mindset and business awareness
- Documentation, knowledge sharing, and reusable contribution
- Risk identification and communication
- Client impact appropriate to level
- Learning and certification expectations

10% Custom Goals

Customization Area	Examples
Project context	Support, development, migration, modernization, data, AI, cloud, platform, or managed services.
Client maturity	Startup-like, enterprise, regulated, high-compliance, product-led, or transformation-heavy.
Individual career path	Individual contributor, lead path, architect path, delivery path, consulting path, or AI specialist path.
Skill gap	Cloud, AI, DevOps, frontend, backend, data engineering, security, observability, architecture, domain.
Account need	Proposal support, accelerator creation, documentation, automation, proof of concept, or client workshop.
Utilization situation	Billable project, bench, partial allocation, internal initiative, pre-sales, or shadow allocation.
Performance maturity	New joiner, high performer, promotion-ready, transition plan, or performance recovery plan.

Example custom goal

For this appraisal cycle, the engineer will build a GenAI-powered test case generation workflow for the current project and demonstrate at least 20% reduction in manual test documentation effort, subject to project approval and data security guidelines.

Promotion-Ready Differentiation by Level

Role	Primary Expectation	AI Expectation	Consulting Expectation
Associate Engineer	Learn and deliver assigned tasks reliably.	Use AI safely for learning and productivity.	Understand basic business context.
Engineer	Independently deliver stories/components.	Use AI to improve own delivery.	Suggest small improvements; no formal mentorship accountability.

Role	Primary Expectation	AI Expectation	Consulting Expectation
Senior Engineer	Own modules and guide juniors.	Implement project-level AI improvements.	Participate in client-facing technical discussions.
Lead Engineer	Own team/workstream delivery.	Drive AI adoption across the team.	Support client confidence and growth.
Engineering Manager	Own delivery, people, utilization, and client success.	Operationalize AI-enabled delivery across teams.	Own CSAT/NPS-adjacent outcomes and delivery-led growth.
Associate Architect	Own solution design areas.	Design AI-enabled workflows and solutions.	Shape solution options and value-adds.
Architect	Own architecture strategy and account impact.	Lead AI transformation and FDE model.	Drive trusted advisor impact and growth.

Market Benchmark Comparison

Traditional performance goals tend to focus on task completion, trainings, generic mentoring, and process adherence. The refined model shifts the organization toward outcome-based performance, AI-enabled productivity, consulting impact, delivery-led growth, and measurable engineering quality.

Traditional Goal	Limitation	Refined Modern Goal
Complete assigned tasks	Too activity-based.	Deliver measurable outcomes with quality, predictability, and low rework.
Attend trainings	Passive and hard to connect to delivery value.	Apply learning to the project, create reusable assets, and demonstrate impact.
Use AI tools	Too vague and can become checkbox behavior.	Use approved AI tools to reduce cycle time, improve quality, automate workflows, and document measurable benefits.
Follow process	Minimum expectation only.	Use process to improve transparency, risk control, and zero-failure governance.
Mentor juniors	Generic and hard to assess.	Mentor named mentees with measurable improvement in independence, quality, and delivery maturity.
Manage project	Broad and subjective.	Own delivery predictability, risks, dependencies, stakeholder communication, quality gates, CSAT/NPS-adjacent outcomes, and project health.
Architecture contribution	Often unclear.	Produce decision records, NFR mapping, reusable patterns, trade-off analysis, and implementation alignment.
Innovation	Often subjective and detached from delivery.	Build practical accelerators, automation, AI workflows, reusable templates, or client-impacting improvements.

Market Direction

- Outcome-based delivery is replacing effort-only tracking.
- Engineering productivity is increasingly measured through quality, flow, reliability, and business value rather than only story points or hours.
- AI is becoming an embedded SDLC capability rather than a side innovation activity.
- Higher-order engineering skills are becoming more important: system design, debugging, judgment, validation, client understanding, and AI orchestration.
- Consulting and engineering are converging; engineers are increasingly expected to understand business value and shape solutions, not just execute tickets.

Final Goal Template for Appraisal Systems

Goal	Objective	Key Results
1. Project Delivery & Engineering Excellence	Deliver assigned project responsibilities with high quality, predictability, ownership, and minimal delivery risk.	Deliver committed scope; maintain code quality, test coverage, documentation, and deployment readiness; reduce rework and defects; identify risks early; contribute to technical decisions; support zero failed projects.
2. AI Enablement, Automation & GenAI Upskilling	Adopt and apply AI responsibly to improve productivity, quality, and delivery maturity.	Complete AI/technical learning; use approved AI tools; build or contribute to AI workflows, agents, automations, or reusable prompts; demonstrate measurable impact; follow responsible AI guidelines; share learnings.
3. Consulting Mindset & Delivery-Led Growth	Demonstrate business understanding, client empathy, and solution-oriented thinking that supports delivery-led growth.	Understand client context; communicate clearly; identify improvement or growth opportunities; support demos/workshops/proposals; convert delivery insights into value-add recommendations.

Goal	Objective	Key Results
4. People, Collaboration & Mentorship - Senior+	Improve collaboration at junior levels and formal mentorship/team capability from Senior Engineer and above.	Associate Engineers and Engineers contribute through collaboration, documentation, peer reviews, and knowledge sharing; Senior Engineers and above own formal mentorship, onboarding support, career guidance, and capability development.
5. Process, Utilization & Compliance	Maintain utilization, governance, security, and organizational discipline.	Meet utilization expectations; maintain timesheets and status updates; follow project/client/org processes; complete mandatory trainings; follow secure coding and responsible AI practices; maintain audit-ready documentation.

Suggested Final Weightage by Role

Role	Delivery	AI Enablement	Consulting / Growth	Collaboration / Mentorship	Compliance
Associate Engineer	45%	25%	5%	15% collaboration only	10%
Engineer	45%	20%	10%	15% collaboration only	10%
Senior Engineer	45%	20%	10%	20%	5%
Lead Engineer	40%	20%	15%	20%	5%
Engineering Manager	35%	20%	20%	20%	5%
Associate Architect	40%	20%	20%	15%	5%
Architect	35%	25%	20%	15%	5%

Implementation Notes

- Use this as the default appraisal goal library, not as a rigid checklist for every individual.
- Each person should have 5 primary goals mapped to the categories above, with role-specific key results selected from this document.
- Managers should add one customized goal based on project context, client context, skill gap, or growth opportunity.
- Every AI goal should include responsible usage and measurable impact; avoid measuring AI adoption only by number of prompts used.
- Every delivery goal should include early risk escalation and evidence-based tracking to support the zero failed projects vision.
- For Senior Engineer and above, include formal mentorship and at least one measurable contribution to reusable assets, client-facing impact, CSAT/NPS-adjacent outcomes, delivery-led growth, architecture maturity, AI-enabled delivery transformation, or Engineering Manager-owned delivery/people/utilization outcomes.

References and Benchmark Sources

The framework is aligned with common engineering performance practices, DORA-style delivery health metrics, and current industry direction around AI-enabled software delivery. These references were used as benchmark anchors while shaping the model.

- DORA - Software delivery performance metrics and engineering excellence guidance:

<https://dora.dev/guides/dora-metrics/>

- McKinsey - Unlocking the value of AI in software development, 2025: <https://www.mckinsey.com/industries/technology-media-and-telecommunications/our-insights/unlocking-the-value-of-ai-in-software-development>

- McKinsey - Superagency in the workplace, 2025: <https://www.mckinsey.com/capabilities/tech-and-ai/our-insights/superagency-in-the-workplace-empowering-people-to-unlock-ais-full-potential-at-work>

- Thoughtworks Technology Radar, 2025 - AI assistance, agents, and enterprise software delivery trends: <https://www.thoughtworks.com/en-in/about-us/news/2025/thoughtworks-tech-radar-33-rapid-ai>

- GenAI in software engineering research themes: productivity, quality, validation, governance, and responsible adoption.

Note: The goals should be reviewed every 6-12 months as AI engineering practices, client expectations, and delivery operating models evolve.